In the first section, you'll learn a definition of *platform*. We'll also dive into *platform thinking*. We'll apply these two concepts so you can understand first and foremost why we are building a platform (product), and then we'll quickly group the target user groups of our platform.

In the second section, you'll learn about *X as a service* and apply this collaboration mode to make the data consumers' work easier.

In the third section, you'll learn about modular plane architectures in the context of platforms, as well as the architecture of a generic platform. We'll apply that to make the data producers' life easier.

In the last section, we will take another round of inspiration from the previously learned concepts and apply them to increase the value for the data producers by a lot.

To make life easier for you, table 7.1 shows the concepts you'll learn in this chapter as well as an overview of the three iterations of our self-serve platform.

Table 7.1 Concepts explained in this chapter

Concepts	Section
Definition of platform and platform thinking	7.1
X as a service	7.2
The architecture of a platform	7.3

The topic of *federated computational governance*, with an emphasis on *computational* (which you discovered in the preceding chapter), is of particular importance. We will highlight it again in each iteration. Let's take a look at our already existing platform.